ARUL MURUGA

Technical Project Manager | Group Technical Architect | AI Transformation & Governance Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Project Manager and Group Technical Architect with 18 years of engineering experience, built on a deep foundation in Linux, networking (TCP/IP), C/C++ and Python, and a long tenure at HCL Technologies on a Cisco Offshore Development Centre. Has progressed from hands-on systems engineering to leading an AI transformation programme across 65 engineers in 8 teams, with 15+ engineers and 7 Technical Leads under direct management. PMP certified, Generative AI Leader (Google Cloud) and AWS Certified AI Practitioner. Working knowledge of Agile/Scrum and Jira from hands-on engineering, currently studying Agile programme management at scale (PSM I in progress). Focused on AI-native engineering delivery, AI governance and measurable business outcomes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 664+ FTE-hours saved through the AI transformation programme in Year 1.
- 93% build-time reduction delivered for the wider engineering organisation.
- 2 AI tools deployed in Year 1 and 6 in Year 2, against a 12-tool target for Year 3.
- 100% SLA compliance sustained across 13+ consecutive weeks.
- 65 engineers across 8 teams, with 7 Technical Leads and 15+ engineers reporting directly.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Technical Project Manager & Group Technical Architect

2010 - Present

HCL Technologies - Cisco Offshore Development Centre (ODC)

Chennai, India

Career progression: Member Technical Staff > Lead Engineer > Technical Lead > Senior Technical Lead > Technical Project Manager.

- Lead an AI transformation programme across the Cisco ODC, driving adoption of AI tooling across engineering teams.
- Manage and mentor a leadership bench of 7 Technical Leads and 15+ engineers directly, within a wider organisation of 65 engineers across 8 teams.
- Own technical architecture and delivery governance, applying Linux, networking, C/C++, Python, Jenkins, Docker and multi-architecture build expertise built over 18 years.
- Apply Agile/Scrum and Jira at engineer level in day-to-day delivery; currently studying Agile programme management at scale (PSM I in progress).
- Head resource demand management for the delivery unit: gather open positions from teams, coordinate candidate sourcing with HR, select interview panelists, collect panel reviews and update HR teams.
- Align AI adoption with the EU AI Act and ISO/IEC 42001, treating governance as a design input rather than retrofitted documentation.
- Handle on-site, remote and 24x7 support teams, monthly process compliance audits (PCA) and SoW renewals.
- Bring 18 years of experience interviewing and training engineers, including running interview panels and developing technical talent.

C Programmer

Aug 2009 - Jun 2010

Digitech Systems and Engineering

Chennai, India

- Developed software solutions for energy meters, integrating internet-based data handling to enhance efficiency and reduce costs.
- Designed and deployed an HTTP server for embedded systems, streamlining data transmission processes.
- Documented technical solutions, fostering knowledge sharing and improving team collaboration.

C Programmer

Jul 2008 - Jul 2009

Iwiz Hitec Solutions

Chennai, India

- Engineered IoT-based solutions, including sensor drivers and interfaces, optimising system performance and reliability.
- Improved PCB designs, enhancing energy efficiency and sensitivity for IoT applications.

- Conducted product demonstrations, showcasing technical capabilities to support business development.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Bachelor of Engineering (BE), Electrical, Electronics and Communications Engineering Aug 2003 - Jul 2007

Anna University - SSN College of Engineering, Chennai, India

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English - C1 - Full professional proficiency
Tamil - Native - Mother tongue
German - A1 - Basic; certification in progress

DIGITAL SKILLS

Engineering & systems: Linux OS, TCP/IP networking, C/C++, Python

Build & delivery: Jenkins, Docker, multi-architecture builds, release engineering, CI/CD

AI & governance: AI transformation, AI adoption measurement, EU AI Act, ISO/IEC 42001

Leadership & delivery: Technical programme management, technical architecture, delivery governance, resource demand management, team leadership

Agile & tooling: Agile/Scrum (working knowledge, engineer level), Jira, Agile programme management at scale (PSM I in progress)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Project Management Professional (PMP) - Project Management Institute (valid to Dec 2027)
- Generative AI Leader - Google Cloud (valid to Sep 2028)
- AWS Certified AI Practitioner - Amazon Web Services (valid to Sep 2029)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Independent project: algorithmic options trading system in Python, with RSI-based signals, GTT stop-loss management, trailing stops and daily loss-cap controls.
- Open to technical programme management, architecture and AI transformation leadership roles in engineering delivery and responsible AI governance.
- Willing to relocate to the job location.
- References available on request.